

WATERING

All your crops will need to be watered frequently, especially during critical stages in their growth (see individual growing guides for details). The most effective way to water a large plot is with a soaker hose, which dribbles water where it is needed at the base of the plant above its roots. A watering can may be all you need for a small plot or patio, but keep in mind that crops in cultivation dry out more quickly than in the ground. Consider a microirrigation system, which

allows you to tailor a precise network of pipes or sprays to your containers or beds and can be automated using a timer.

Water in the cool of the morning or evening to reduce evaporation. Direct the water at the soil and not at the leaves—this is not only ineffectual, but if you water plants on a hot day, you also risk burning them. Remember, too, that soaking plants twice a week is better than spraying them lightly every day, and it will encourage stronger, deeper roots.



Keep young, leafy crops well supplied with water.